

Basic Syntactic Units: Clauses

- **Clause:**
 - Semantically: “the description of some activity, state or property”
- Simple clauses have a predicate, core arguments (usually subjects and objects), and non-core arguments (e.g., location, manner, instrument)
 - “John **kicked** the ball”
 - “The door **opened**”
 - “The door silently **opened**”
 - “John **opened** the door with a hammer”
 - “John is **tall**”

Inter-Clause Relations

- Three main inter-relations between clauses within a sentence: complement clauses, relative clauses, linked clauses, coordination
- Complement clauses:
 - Clauses that serve as an argument in another clause
 - “John said **he will kick the ball**”
 - “Mary convinced Paul **to join them**”
- Coordination:
 - “**I got home** and **took a shower**”
- Relative clauses:
 - Clauses that modify an argument of another clause
 - “John, **who has studied the language for years**, speaks German well”
 - “Dogs **that bark** never bite”
- Linked clauses:
 - After **he had studied it for years**, **John could speak German well**
 - Although **he had studied it for years**, **John could speak German well**